Christian da Costa

Legal Engineering & Legal Operations | Legal Tech & Legal AI | Jurimetrics & KPIs

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OAB/PR 89.297 | Master of Laws (LL.M., UFPR) | Curitiba/PR, Brazil; available for São Paulo/SP
Portfolio: christiancozta.github.io/arco.html | linkedin.com/in/christiandcosta

Over 5 years leading high-volume legal operations; led a team of 8 staff in a continuous queue, with a 30-day ceiling per agenda and progression conditioned on batch clean-up. Between Dec 2025 and Apr 2026, productivity, measured by conversion into opinions, rose by **16.2 pp**, and the rate of cases beyond the ceiling fell by **29.8 pp**. Designed and implemented a legal AI architecture in judicial chambers; using it since the individual phase, concurrently with management, recorded a conversion rate of **59.30%**, above the overall average (51.05%). Original indicators, calculated from raw data, with no native equivalent.

Projects

Legal AI System – ATRIO **11/2025–Present**

2nd Appellate Panel, TJPR | CERNE Demo: christiancozta.github.io/arco.html#cerne

- My own project, implemented by judicial authorization, with *individual* use starting in Nov 2025 and *collective* use from Feb 2026 to May 2026; it continues to be versioned.
- Design of a legal AI system with 4 modules, governed by versioned manuals, for memory, decision support, governance, and data anonymization (LGPD; CNJ Resolution 615/2025); integrating online LLMs, a corpus of **115,114** rulings, and systems via a local API built on FastAPI and PostgreSQL; in RATIO, median time to first draft ruling of about **10 min**.
- Development of CERNE, a mechanism for the critical governance of legal reasoning that preserves argumentative support; the operational expression of an original concept under research (DOI 10.5281/zenodo.22892157).

Legal Ops Operating Model – ECHO **09/2025–11/2025**

4th Appellate Panel, TJPR | Playbook Demo: christiancozta.github.io/arco.html#play

- Design of a methodology for high-volume legal operations with no established procedure, built on an intake, classification, distribution, verification, production, and memory chain; implemented in chambers by judicial authorization.
- Taxonomy design: **90.2%** reduction in systemic classification complexity (102 subjects consolidated into 10 categories), with distribution across three teams; early triage of **1,192** cases in **30** days and predefined routing for **56%** of the caseload.
- Consolidation of the reference collection into a single-access digital playbook (PLAY), with unified search and stage-by-stage order of use: 4 manuals, 2 SOPs, a base of 2,758 headnote templates aligned with the CNJ taxonomy, 107 legal grounds, and a conditional draft-ruling builder.

Legal Analytics Framework – DATA **02/2022–05/2026**

Paraná State Court of Justice (TJPR)

- Building of an original KPI for conversion into opinions from raw operational data, not available as native metrics, for performance tracking, with published counting rules and thresholds.
- Measurement of operational performance, identifying a reduction of the time tail (over 30 days) from 36.5% to **6.7%** (down 29.8 pp), an increase of **23%** in completed volume (throughput), and a decline of **24%** in the open backlog.

Professional Experience

Paraná State Court of Justice (TJPR) **01/2021–05/2026**

Chief of Staff | *Tax Enforcement and Appellate Panels (Civil, Public, and Tax Law)* *01/2022–05/2026*

- Leadership of high-volume legal operations, with a team of 8 staff, pipeline and queue management, workload balancing, and tracking of SLA/aging, productivity, quality, and deadlines.

- Steering of the transition to, and management of, appellate operations (Sep 2025); at the 4th Appellate Panel, end-to-end operations modeling; at the 2nd Appellate Panel, productivity (conversion into opinions) rose from 44.2% to **60.4%**.
- Operation of SISBAJUD in tax enforcement cases and team training; in Jul 2024, led the review of **1,543** enforcement cases, resulting in 257 dismissals and further clean-up of the portfolio.
- Work redesign through AS-IS/TO-BE mapping, with bottleneck diagnosis, standardization of procedures into playbooks, onboarding, technical training, and team mentoring.

Legal Advisor | *Tax Enforcement* *01/2021–12/2021*

- Backlog reduction under a set deadline, with clean-up of **2,000+** cases in 90 days and dismissal of **300+** time-barred proceedings, in preparation for an institutional inspection, working directly with the Court Clerk's Office.
- Integration into the Núcleo 4.0 project, receiving **36,000+** tax enforcement cases and structuring segmentation, prioritization, and portfolio management criteria (matter management).

Strategic Tax Litigation and Advisory **09/2017–01/2021**

Lawyer | *L. Vernalha & Moro Advogados* *08/2020–01/2021*
Lawyer | *A. Augusto Grellert Advogados Associados* *12/2019–08/2020*
Lawyer | *Domingues Sociedade de Advogados* *09/2017–09/2019*

- Strategic judicial and administrative litigation involving federal, state, and municipal taxes, with technical legal drafting, liability analysis, and definition of procedural strategies.
- Risk analysis and contingency provisioning, with legal opinions and assessments to support business decisions.
- Tax advisory to individuals with income and assets abroad, covering personal income tax (IRPF), international taxation, change of tax residence, and definitive departure from Brazil.

Education

Master of Laws (LL.M.) **01/2023–01/2025**
Federal University of Paraná (UFPR)

Bachelor of Laws (LL.B.) **06/2013–06/2017**
UniBrasil University Center

Skills

- **Legal Operations and Processes:** pipeline, queue, and backlog management; SLA/aging; legal intake & triage; workload balancing; Process Mapping (AS-IS/TO-BE); Workflow Design; SOPs and playbooks; KPI Management.

- **Data and Jurimetrics:** Legal Analytics; building and validation of indicators; counting rules and denominators; time series; Data Governance and Data Quality.

- **Knowledge and Information Architecture:** Knowledge Management; taxonomy; Metadata Management; Corpus Engineering; Information Extraction; controlled vocabulary.

- **Legal Engineering and AI Governance:** Decision Support Systems; Business Rules; Requirements Management; Human-in-the-Loop; Quality Gates; traceability; Adversarial Review and LLM Evaluation; Privacy by Design (LGPD; CNJ Resolution 615/2025; Bill 2338/2023; EU AI Act).

- **Tools:** Python (FastAPI, Selenium, BeautifulSoup, pandas); PostgreSQL and SQL; Docker; Ollama; OCR; DataJud API; Claude Code; Codex; SISBAJUD; Projudi; advanced Excel; Power Automate; Microsoft 365.

Languages

Portuguese native; **English** advanced; **Spanish** intermediate.